

FORGE Phase 1 · Week 6 · Session 18 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 18: Mediation Skills" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 18 as written runs about 100 minutes. This insert adds two short videos and one talk, which fills the session to two hours.

What's in this insert

- **Video 18A, "The Neutral Third Party"** (1 min 50 s). Everything the men have learned so far, and the hardest piece still to come; what neutral means and what it does not mean, side by side; why taking sides ends a mediation; and "You're not the judge. You're the mirror." It ends on the check-in question and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 18B, "When Both Men Are Heated"** (1 min 40 s). The guide's five steps for two escalated parties, one at a time: separate first, acknowledge the heat, the more escalated man goes first, find the overlap, and take a break if it stalls. It ends on "Many conflicts are resolved between mediation sessions, not during them."
- **A talk on curiosity in conflict:** Karleen Savage, *A hostage negotiator on how to resolve conflict* (TEDxValparaisoUniversity, 10 minutes 10 seconds), with discussion questions.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Video 18A, "The Neutral Third Party"	2	Play it as soon as the men are seated, with the talking piece in the center.
0:02	Opening Circle	10	Start the round on the question the video ends on.
0:12	Instruction: The Neutral Third Party	15	The video gave both lists and "the mirror." Spend the time on the guide's "one exception" (you enforce the ground rules) and on one question: "Has anyone ever taken your side in a conflict? What happened to the other man's trust in him?"
0:27	Instruction: Mediation vs. Taking Sides	10	As written: triangulation, and "I'll help you both, but I won't be a messenger."
0:37	Instruction: Setting Ground Rules	10	As written, with the six ground rules on display. Model asking for a verbal commitment to each one.
0:47	Talk: Karleen Savage, A hostage negotiator on how to resolve conflict	11	Introduce it in one sentence: "She's a trained hostage and crisis negotiator. Listen for what she does instead of deciding who's right."
0:58	Talk discussion	5	Questions below.

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
1:03	Instruction: Managing Two Escalated Parties	15	Play Video 18B first. It gives the five steps. Then teach each one with the guide's lines, especially why the man with more heat goes first.
1:18	Exercise: Triad Mediation Practice	30	As written: three scenarios, with roles rotating, and the 8-minute debrief. Her three questions (below) make a good self-check for each mediator.
1:48	Closing Circle	10	As written, with next week's homework.
1:58	Buffer	2	

Discussion questions for the Karleen Savage talk

1. She asks three questions after a hard conversation: Did you allow them their own independent story? Could you hear it without backlash? Did their perspective inform the solution? Which of those is hardest for a mediator in this dorm?
2. She says staying curious is hardest when you're wrapped up in your own side. When is it hardest for you to stay neutral? Where does your bias show up? (*This is also tonight's journal question.*)
3. A negotiator doesn't decide who's right. What does she do instead? How is that like being "the mirror"?
4. Her five skills are curiosity, attitude, listening, connection and reframing. Which one will you need most in the triad practice today?

Preview the talk before the session. She draws on her work as a crisis and hostage negotiator, which can involve people in crisis. Check how she describes those calls, and check the talk against the facility's rules for outside media.

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *A hostage negotiator on how to resolve conflict* — **YouTube** (TEDx Talks): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jUF9sY4HvxY> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/karleen_savage_a_hostage_negotiator_on_how_to_resolve_conflict

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Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 18A and 18B loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Talk loaded, previewed, and cleared under the facility's media rules
- ☐ Mediation Ground Rules display ready; room set for groups of three